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Mandatory Organic Recycling Program

California State law (Senate Bill 1383) requires all residents, multi-family complexes, and businesses to recycle organic materials (i.e. food waste and green waste.)

The new requirements are part of a statewide effort to reduce harmful methane emissions. Recycling organic waste is a small change with big environmental benefits. Composting food scraps and green waste reduces the amount of waste that is taken to landfills, a major source of methane emissions. If everyone in the United States composted their food waste, the impact would be equivalent to removing 7.8 million cars from the road.

The City of Claremont offers programs to meet the needs of our residents and businesses. Please see below for program details.

Residential Organic Recycling

All residential customers must place food scraps in the green waste container (green lid) rather than in the trash container (black lid). Items placed in the green container will be composted for more sustainable processing. The only thing that will change is how you sort your food scraps. Your trash, recycling, and green containers will still be serviced the same day, place, and time. We simply ask that you place any food scraps in the green container.

Suitable food scraps include fruits and vegetables, grains, meats, bones, dry/solid dairy products, eggshells, and coffee grounds. Green waste including grass clippings, leaves, plant prunings, flowers, twigs, and small branches (less than 4 inches in diameter and 4 feet long) should also continue to be placed in the green container. As a courtesy reminder, palm fronds, cacti, succulents, dirt, rock, and animal waste are not compostable and should always be placed in the trash container. Palm fronds in particular are a significant source of contamination, which can lead to increased costs.

 Organics	 Recycle	 Trash
California State Law Requires Customers to Recycle Food and Organic Waste Yes  All Food Waste May be bagged in CLEAR plastic bags Plate scrapings, fruits, veggies, sandwiches, pizza, eggshells, coffee grounds, breads, grains, bones, meat, cheese, dairy, seafood, etc.  Organic Waste Leaves, grass clippings, plant prunings, flowers, weeds, and small branches (less than 4 inches in diameter and 4 feet in length), etc.  Food Scrap Kitchen Pails are available for a fee. Call us at (909) 399-5431. Organics tips at: www.claremontca.org/organicrecycling	All Recyclables Should Be Empty, Clean, and Dry Yes  Plastic Containers Plastics #1 and #2 only  Glass Bottles & Jars (Labels do not need to be removed)  Metal Cans  Paper Place recyclables loosely in the container (no trash bags). Bagged recyclables will be sent to landfill.	Yes  Non-Recyclable Plastic and Paper Plastic bags, milk & egg cartons, juice boxes, frozen food boxes, plastic film, utensils, plastic clam shells, dirty napkins, to-go cups, paper towels, baby wipes, greasy pizza boxes, windowed envelopes, etc.  Shredded Paper (Please bag)  Styrofoam To-go containers, cups, packaging materials, etc.  Kitchen Grease (In a sealed container)  Non-Recyclable Materials Padded envelopes, hoses, clothes/textiles, dishware, ceramics, cds, foil, etc.  Hard Plastics #3-7 Buckets, toys, black plastic, microwavable food trays, flower pots, etc.
No  Palm fronds • succulents/cacti • paper napkins • grease • large wood/stumps • animal waste • compostable dinnerware • etc.	No  Plastic bags/films • hard plastics • cartons • mixed materials (padded/windowed envelopes) • bagged mail/magazines • see Trash section	No  Electronic waste • hazardous waste • paint • batteries • light bulb • etc.

Tips for Collecting Food Scraps

- Use a reusable container with a tight-fitting lid to collect food scraps in your kitchen.
- Empty your food waste container into the green barrel every few days. Wash your kitchen container frequently with hot water and detergent.
- Layer food waste between layers of green waste to help keep your container tidy.
- Chill it! Put leftovers in a container and keep them in your refrigerator or freezer until close to collection day.
- When needed, residents can place messy food waste in **clear** plastic bags. Using clear bags allows the composting company to inspect the bag's contents before opening. Plastic bags can then be removed and discarded. Bags do not need to be compostable or biodegradable since they will be removed at the facility, but they must be see-through. Since plastic bags contribute to the waste stream, we recommend trying the above options first.

Countertop Composting Pails Available for Purchase

To help residents collect food scraps in their homes, the City is now offering 2-gallon countertop composting pails. The pails have a snap-tight lid, hand grips for dumping, a locking seal to prevent odors, and are dishwasher safe. They are small enough to sit on the counter or be placed under the sink or in a cabinet. To purchase a countertop container or for pricing information, residents are encouraged to contact the Community Services Department at (909) 399-5431.



Benefits of Composting

While reducing food waste is the most important step we can take to save money and lead a more sustainable life, composting is a more sustainable alternative to landfill. Claremont's Sustainable City Plan sets ambitious targets for reducing our carbon footprint and protecting our climate and composting helps further those goals.

- Recycling food and organic waste helps to reduce harmful methane emissions that contribute to global warming. In landfills, food waste produces a lot of methane, a potent greenhouse gas that causes climate change.
- Compost helps enrich and return valuable nutrients to our soil.
- To learn more about composting at home, please contact Sustainable Claremont at outreach@sustainableclaremont.org (<mailto:outreach@sustainableclaremont.org>).